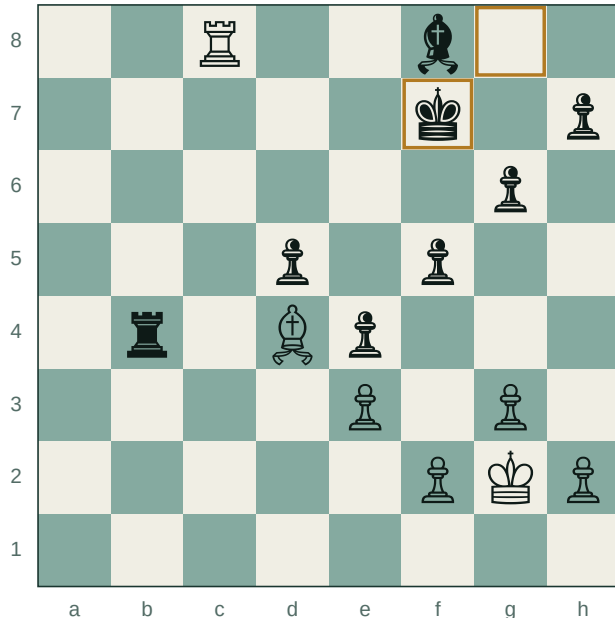


Attraction tactics: White, move 37

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 36...Kf7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37. Rxf8+ Kxf8 38. Bc5+ Kf7 39. Bxb4

37.Rxf8+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the bishop on f8. Recorded reply: **37...Kxf8**.

38.Bc5+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From c5 it attacks king on f8 and rook on b4. Recorded reply: **38...Kf7**.

39.Bxb4 The bishop captures the rook on b4.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on f7. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.